

Yelp Masterclass Guide

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Yelp can be a goldmine or a money pit for cleaning companies. This guide covers profile optimization, review strategy, keyword targeting, and when paid Yelp leads actually make sense.

Yelp Reality Check

Myth	Truth
"Yelp hides good reviews"	Yelp filters suspicious reviews — earn reviews organically and they stick
"More reviews = more calls"	Rating + recent reviews + complete profile drive calls
"Yelp ads always work"	Ads amplify a good profile; they can't fix a bad one
"Yelp is dying"	Still top 3 for local home services in most US metros

Goal: Build a profile that converts searchers into booked jobs at positive ROI.

Phase 1: Profile Setup (Day 1)

Claim & Verify

1. Search your business at biz.yelp.com
2. Claim listing or create new if missing
3. Verify by phone or email
4. Add all service categories

Primary Categories (Choose Carefully)

Priority	Category
Primary	House Cleaners
Secondary	Home Cleaning

Additional	Office Cleaning, Move-In/Move-Out Cleaning, Janitorial Services
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Business Information — Complete 100%

Field	Best Practice
Business name	Exact legal/DBA name — no keyword stuffing
Address	Service area city (hide address if home-based per Yelp rules)
Phone	Tracking number or main line — answer live
Website	Your booking page, not Facebook
Hours	Match reality; note "by appointment" if needed
Service area	All cities you actually serve (don't overreach)
Year established	Builds trust
Licenses/insurance	Upload certificates if applicable

About Section (750 characters)

Template:

[Your Company Name] provides professional residential and commercial cleaning in [City] and surrounding areas including [City 2], [City 3]. We specialize in recurring maintenance cleans, deep cleaning, move-in/move-out service, and Airbnb turnovers. Every cleaner is background-checked, trained to our SOPs, and insured. Book online at [website] or call [phone] for a same-day quote. Serving [Area] since [Year].

Keywords to weave naturally: house cleaning, deep clean, move-out, recurring, [your city name]

Phase 2: Photos (The Highest-ROI Free Task)

Yelp profiles with **25+ photos** get significantly more engagement.

Photo Shot List

Type	Qty	Tips
Before/after bathrooms	5+	Same angle, good lighting

Before/after kitchens	5+	Clear counter transformation
Team in branded shirts	3+	Faces build trust
Supplies/equipment	3+	Professional caddy, organized
Happy client (with permission)	2+	Not required but powerful
Logo / branded vehicle	2+	Recognition

Photo Rules

- No stock photos — Yelp and clients spot fakes
- No client-identifying clutter (mail, family photos) without blur
- Upload 2–3 new photos monthly
- Geotag not required but caption with service type

Phase 3: Keywords & SEO on Yelp

Yelp ranks in Google AND internal search. Optimize for both.

Target Keywords

Build content around what people search:

- house cleaning [city]
- maid service [city]
- deep cleaning [city]
- move out cleaning [city]
- recurring house cleaner [city]
- Airbnb cleaning [city]

Where Keywords Go

Location	How
Business name	City only if part of legal name — don't spam
Categories	Max out relevant categories
About section	2–3 natural keyword mentions
Services (if available)	List every service with city

Reviews	You can't control text, but happy clients often mention "deep clean" etc.
Photo captions	"Deep clean kitchen — [City]"

Service Area Strategy

List every city within your **30-minute drive zone** — not the whole state.

Phase 4: Getting Reviews (The Right Way)

Yelp Review Policies — Follow Strictly

Do:

- Ask happy clients verbally after a great clean
- Send a follow-up text with direct Yelp link
- Put Yelp badge on website and email signature
- Respond to every review (positive and negative)

Do NOT:

- Offer discounts for Yelp reviews (prohibited)
- Ask employees to review you
- Buy reviews
- Review gate (only sending happy clients to Yelp)
- Use review solicitation software that violates Yelp TOS

Review Request Timing

When	Conversion
Right after compliment	Highest — strike while hot
Same day follow-up text	Strong
24-hour email	Good
7 days later	Lower but still worth it

Direct Review Link

Find yours: [Yelp for Business](#) → [Grow your business](#) → [Share review request link](#)

Text template:

Hi [Name]! We're so glad you loved today's clean. If you have 60 seconds, a Yelp review helps other [City] families find us: [Yelp Review Link]. Thank you! — [Your Name], [Company]

Review Response Templates

5-star:

Thank you, [Name]! It was our pleasure cleaning your home in [Neighborhood]. We look forward to your next visit! — [Owner Name], [Company]

3-star or below:

[Name], thank you for the honest feedback. We'd like to make this right — please call me directly at [phone] so we can address your concerns. — [Owner Name]

Never argue publicly on Yelp.

Phase 5: Yelp Ads & Leads — When to Buy

Yelp Advertising Options

Product	What It Does	Typical Cost
Enhanced Profile	Badge, removal of competitor ads on your page	\$300–\$600/mo
Yelp Ads	Appear in search results and competitor pages	\$500–\$1,500+/mo
Cost Per Click (CPC)	Pay when someone clicks	\$8–\$25/click cleaning
Yelp Leads / Connected	Pay per lead (message, call, quote request)	Varies

When Yelp Ads Make Sense

Green lights (consider ads):

- 4.5+ star rating with 15+ reviews
- Profile 100% complete with 20+ photos
- You answer calls within 2 rings / respond to messages in 1 hour
- You can close 30%+ of leads at your target margin
- You've tracked CPA: Cost Per Acquired customer

Red lights (fix first, don't advertise):

- Under 4.0 stars
- Fewer than 10 reviews
- No online booking or slow follow-up
- You don't know your profit per job

ROI Calculation

Monthly Yelp ad spend:	\$800
Clicks received:	80
Leads (calls + messages):	20 (25% click-to-lead)
Booked jobs:	6 (30% close rate)
Average job value:	\$180
Revenue from Yelp:	\$1,080

First-month ROI: $(\$1,080 - \$800) / \$800 = 35\%$

BUT factor in:

- Recurring value (a \$150 bi-weekly client = \$3,900/year)
- Time to respond
- Callback / quality costs

A \$150 bi-weekly client acquired for \$800 is a win if they stay 6+ months.

Negotiating Yelp

- Yelp reps call constantly — you can negotiate
- Ask for 3-month trial at reduced rate
- Request waived setup fees
- Get CPC cap in writing
- Review contract — many auto-renew

Yelp vs. Google Ads

Factor	Yelp	Google
Intent	High — actively searching cleaning	High — broader
Cost	Often higher CPC	More control with skill
Profile importance	Critical (they see you on Yelp)	Lands on your site

Best for	Businesses with strong Yelp presence	Everyone at scale
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Run both only when each channel is profitable independently.

Phase 6: Yelp Messages & Calls

Response Time Target

Channel	Target
Yelp message	Under 1 hour (business hours)
Phone call	Answer live or callback within 15 min
Quote request	Send estimate within 2 hours

Yelp Message Script

Hi [Name]! Thanks for reaching out to [Company]. I'd love to get you a quote.

Quick questions:

1. What city is the home in?
2. How many bedrooms and bathrooms?
3. Regular maintenance or deep clean?
4. How often – one-time or recurring?

You can also book directly here: [link]

Talk soon!

[Your Name]

Phase 7: Competitor Intelligence

Monthly Yelp Audit (15 minutes)

- ☐ Search "house cleaners [your city]" — where do you rank?
- ☐ Click top 3 competitors — what do their profiles have that you don't?
- ☐ Read their negative reviews — what do clients complain about? (That's your marketing angle)

- ☐ Note their pricing mentions in reviews
- ☐ Upload 2 new photos to stay active

Differentiation Angles Clients Care About

- Background-checked cleaners
- Same cleaner every visit
- Online booking and pay
- Supplies included
- Satisfaction guarantee
- Locally owned

Phase 8: Handling Negative Yelp Reviews

Prevention First

- Post-clean text: "Anything we missed? Reply before you review."
- Fix issues within 24 hours
- Document with photos

If You Get a Bad Review

1. **Breathe** — don't respond for 2 hours
2. **Investigate** — check job notes, photos, cleaner account
3. **Respond professionally** — offer offline resolution
4. **Fix if legitimate** — offer re-clean
5. **Flag only if fake** — competitor, never a client, violates TOS

Yelp rarely removes reviews. Your best defense is drowning bad reviews with good ones.

90-Day Yelp Action Plan

Week	Action
1	Claim profile, complete all fields, upload 15 photos
2	Ask 5 best clients for reviews
3	Add services, refine About section with keywords

4	Respond to all existing reviews
5–8	Ask every happy client; upload 2 photos/week
9	Audit competitors, calculate if ready for ads
10–12	Test Yelp ads at \$300–500/mo if criteria met; track every lead

Metrics Dashboard

Track monthly:

Metric	Target
Star rating	4.7+
Total reviews	+4/month growth
Profile views	Trending up
Calls/messages from Yelp	Log every one
Close rate	30%+
Cost per booked job	< 25% of first job revenue
Recurring conversion	40% of one-time → recurring

*Yelp rewards consistency over hacks. Build the profile, earn the reviews, then amplify with ads.
100% Cleaner / The Cleaning CEO Blueprint.*